

Value Proposition Canvas

SLIBRARY 03 · SHEET 4 / 5

Gains, pains, jobs vs. products & services

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Value Proposition Canvas is a tool that maps a customer profile — jobs, pains and gains — against a value map of products, pain relievers and gain creators, to test the fit between what is offered and what is needed.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Created by Alexander Osterwalder, Yves Pigneur and colleagues at Strategyzer, building on the Business Model Canvas (2010) and detailed in Value Proposition Design (2014).

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

It was developed to make the often-implicit logic of a value proposition explicit and testable, reducing the risk of building things customers do not want.

FIGURE 1 · VALUE PROPOSITION CANVAS



Figure 1. A schematic of the Value Proposition Canvas as applied in BARBM312 (illustrative).

HOW IT IS USED

The customer profile is completed first; the value map is then designed to relieve the most severe pains and create the most wanted gains, and fit is checked.

WHEN IT IS USED

During product design, opportunity validation and when shaping AI features around real customer jobs.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Product, innovation and marketing teams.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

It operationalises Jobs To Be Done into a visual, testable fit between offer and need, widely adopted as a standard innovation tool.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

Embedded vs. AI-Native 2x2 · Slibrary 3

Build · Buy · Partner · Slibrary 3

Legacy Modernisation Curve · Slibrary 3

Data Network Effects · Slibrary 3

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Osterwalder, A. et al. (2014) Value Proposition Design. Hoboken: Wiley.

Osterwalder, A. and Pigneur, Y. (2010) Business Model Generation. Hoboken: Wiley.